

Huddling, diatonic and pentatonic scales in $\mathbb{Z}_{12}$: Fourier maxima and convex-energy minima formalized in Lean 4

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github.com/karlesmarin/music-math

Abstract

The diatonic collection solves two optimization problems on the twelve pitch classes: it maximizes the magnitude of the fifth discrete Fourier coefficient and minimizes an all-pairs energy for every decreasing, discretely convex potential. We formalize the connection in Lean 4. The route begins with the twelve-tone Huddling theorem: at each cardinality, consecutive pitch classes maximize the first Fourier magnitude, with equality exactly on their transposition orbit. Multiplication by five transports this maximum to frequency five; at cardinality seven, the resulting orbit is precisely the diatonic orbit. An Abel summation identity supplies the energy side. Under strict convexity and decrease, the two equality classes coincide: for every seven-note set A , $|\hat{A}(5)| = 2 + \sqrt{3}$ if and only if $E_V(A) = E_V(D)$. The contribution is a connected formalization of classical mathematics in $\mathbb{Z}_{12}$, with exact algebraic comparisons, explicit equality conditions, and independently reproducible cyclotomic checks. Two finite certificates use trusted compiled evaluation (`native_decide`); the axiom audit makes these dependencies explicit. A symbolic complement-energy identity transfers the result to five-note pentatonic sets without another census. Homometry, tritone transposition, and the parity coefficient connect the argument to the earlier notes.

Keywords: Huddling lemma; diatonic scale; pentatonic scale; pitch-class sets; discrete Fourier transform; maximal evenness; convex energy; Lean 4.

1 Why do the same seven notes appear twice?

The seven white keys of the piano give the pitch-class collection $D = \{0, 2, 4, 5, 7, 9, 11\}$, with $C = 0$. On the twelve-position pitch-class clock they are spread around the circle. Read in a different order, they form a consecutive chain of fifths. These two views lead to two precise extremal properties of the same collection.

*Prepared with the assistance of artificial intelligence tools, building on the author's earlier Lean development. The mathematical results are classical; the author is responsible for the statements, attribution, and interpretation. The formal artifact and its trust dependencies are described in Section 8.

P₀. Why does this seven-note collection maximize a Fourier magnitude and also minimize a repulsive pair energy?

The historical routes to the question were different. Lewin’s 1959 note on intervallic relations [1] supplied an early Fourier viewpoint. Clough and Douthett’s 1991 study [2] developed maximal evenness as a property of scales. Amiot recalls a more specific meeting of these ideas: the John Clough Memorial Days in Chicago in July 2005, where Quinn’s dissertation helped revive Lewin’s Fourier approach to chord quality [5]. The occasion is a useful reminder that a change of mathematical language can make connections in familiar musical material visible.

Douthett and Krantz connected maximally even configurations to interaction energies and one-dimensional spin models [6]. Amiot developed the Fourier characterization [3]. This note follows the connection between those viewpoints at one fixed scale. Its thread is the diatonic collection throughout: first seen as a rearranged chromatic cluster, then as a Fourier maximizer, and finally as an energy minimizer. The Lean statements make the change of coordinates and the equality class explicit.

2 The change of coordinates

For an unweighted set $A \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_{12}$, use the unnormalized DFT

$$\hat{A}(t) = \sum_{a \in A} e^{-2\pi i a t / 12}, \quad S_t(A) = |\hat{A}(t)|^2. \quad (1)$$

In Lean, A is a `Finset (ZMod 12)` and the transform is Mathlib’s `ZMod.dft` applied to its indicator. The complex-valued `Fourier.powerSpec` has real part $S_t(A)$; the bridge to the squared norm is `Huddling.powerSpec_re_eq_norm_sq`. Transposition $T_s A = A + s$ changes phase and preserves S_t . *P₁. Which coordinates turn a consecutive chromatic cluster into a diatonic collection?*

For a unit $u \in \mathbb{Z}_{12}^\times$, put $M_u A = \{ua : a \in A\}$. Reindexing the finite sum gives

$$\widehat{M_u A}(t) = \hat{A}(ut). \quad (2)$$

This is `MTransform.Ahat_mul`. Multiplication by five is its own inverse modulo twelve, so it preserves cardinality and exchanges frequencies one and five. Five semitones is a fourth, the reverse direction around the circle of fifths; this orientation has no effect on the transposition class at issue here. For $C_7 = \{0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6\}$,

$$T_{11} M_5 C_7 = D, \quad M_5 D = T_7 C_7.$$

Both identities are checked on the same set definitions used in the theorems.

3 What Huddling contributes

The roots-of-unity lemma recorded by Amiot [5, Lemma 2] says that consecutive roots maximize the magnitude of a sum of distinct roots. Here we certify its twelve-tone instance and the complete equality class.

Theorem 1 (Huddling in $\mathbb{Z}_{12}$). *For every $A \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_{12}$, with $k = |A|$ and $C_k = \{0, \dots, k-1\}$,*

$$S_1(A) \leq S_1(C_k), \quad S_1(A) = S_1(C_k) \iff A = T_s C_k \text{ for some } s \in \mathbb{Z}_{12}.$$

The same inequality and equality condition hold for Fourier magnitudes.

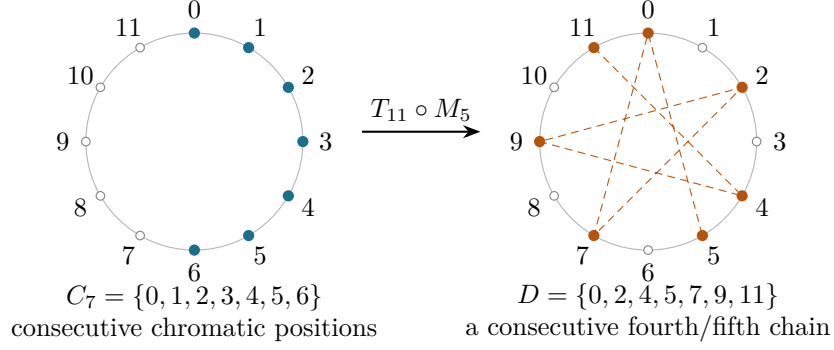


Figure 1: The same seven positions in two coordinates. Filled nodes denote membership; the dashed path on the right follows repeated addition of five, from 11 to 5. The map permutes pitch classes and Fourier indices, carrying the first-frequency cluster problem to the fifth-frequency diatonic problem.

The formal proof reduces the comparison to an exact decidable order. If $i_j(A)$ counts *unordered* pairs at circular distance j , the autocorrelation/DFT bridge from `Fourier.lean` gives

$$2S_1(A) = P(A) + Q(A)\sqrt{3}, \quad (3)$$

where

$$P(A) = 2|A| + 2i_2(A) - 2i_4(A) - 4i_6(A), \quad Q(A) = 2i_1(A) - 2i_5(A).$$

The factor at the tritone matters: the interval-vector convention here counts each unordered tritone once. `MTransform.psZ` represents the right-hand side in $\mathbb{Z}[\sqrt{3}]$; `powerSpec_one_re_le_iff` proves that its decidable comparison agrees with real Fourier power. No rounded trigonometric values enter the proof.

The finite certificate bounds all $2^{12} = 4096$ sets and identifies every equality witness. The converse equality implication uses transposition invariance symbolically. Table 1 makes the finite scope and exact constants visible. At cardinalities zero and twelve there is one maximizing set; at every intermediate cardinality there are twelve, precisely the twelve distinct rotations of a proper consecutive arc.

k	Sets checked	$2S_1(C_k)$	Maximizers
0, 12	1 each	0	1 each
1, 11	12 each	2	12 each
2, 10	66 each	$4 + 2\sqrt{3}$	12 each
3, 9	220 each	$8 + 4\sqrt{3}$	12 each
4, 8	495 each	$12 + 6\sqrt{3}$	12 each
5, 7	792 each	$14 + 8\sqrt{3}$	12 each
6	924	$16 + 8\sqrt{3}$	12

Table 1: The exact Huddling census. Complementary cardinalities share the nonzero-frequency maximum, in agreement with the complement identity of `Fourier.lean`.

P₂. What does the cluster maximum say about the seven white keys?

Apply Theorem 1 to M_5A and use Equation (2). For $|A| = 7$ the result is

$$S_5(A) \leq S_5(D) = 7 + 4\sqrt{3}, \quad |\hat{A}(5)| \leq 2 + \sqrt{3}. \quad (4)$$

Equality holds exactly on $\mathcal{O}_D = \{T_s D : s \in \mathbb{Z}_{12}\}$. The inversions of D already belong to this orbit, so the transposition and T/I descriptions name the same twelve sets. This is why the word *diatonic* is appropriate for this Fourier extremum: the characterization singles out the collection up to transposition, rather than selecting a tonic or one of its modal orderings.

4 Why the energy selects the same collection

P₃. Can the equality class be recovered by measuring separation between every pair of notes?

Write $d(a, b) = \min((a - b) \bmod 12, (b - a) \bmod 12)$. For a real potential $V : \{1, \dots, 6\} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, the all-pairs energy is

$$E_V(A) = \sum_{\{a,b\} \subseteq A} V(d(a, b)) = \sum_{j=1}^6 i_j(A) V(j). \quad (5)$$

We call V admissible when

$$\Delta^2 V(j) := V(j) - 2V(j+1) + V(j+2) \geq 0 \quad (1 \leq j \leq 4), \quad V(6) \leq V(5). \quad (6)$$

These hypotheses imply that V is nonincreasing: its first differences are nondecreasing, and the last is nonpositive. Strict admissibility means that all five displayed inequalities are strict. No particular formula or positivity assumption on V is required.

The proof reuses the symbolic engine in `AllPairsEvenness.lean`. For $|A| = 7$, set $d_j = i_{j+1}(A) - i_{j+1}(D)$, $0 \leq j \leq 5$, and

$$H_j = \sum_{\ell=0}^j (j+1-\ell) d_\ell.$$

Both sets have $\binom{7}{2} = 21$ pairs, so $\sum_{j=0}^5 d_j = 0$. Double Abel summation then gives

$$E_V(A) - E_V(D) = \sum_{j=0}^3 H_j \Delta^2 V(j+1) + H_4 (V(5) - V(6)). \quad (7)$$

This identity is proved algebraically for arbitrary real V , independently of the census. The finite input is that $H_0, \dots, H_4 \geq 0$ for every seven-note set, and some $H_j > 0$ outside $\mathcal{O}_D$. On $\mathcal{O}_D$ the whole interval vector agrees with that of D . Equation (7) therefore establishes a minimum for every admissible potential, and identifies its equality class under the strict hypotheses.

Theorem 2 (Diatonic energy minimum). *For every admissible V and every $A \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_{12}$ with $|A| = 7$, $E_V(D) \leq E_V(A)$. If V is strictly admissible, then*

$$E_V(A) = E_V(D) \iff A \in \mathcal{O}_D.$$

Strictness is essential to the equality statement. For the constant potential $V = 1$, every seven-note set has energy 21, while only twelve maximize S_5 . The weak minimum theorem thus cannot be substituted for the strict uniqueness theorem in the connection below.

5 The two questions have one equality class

We can now return to P_0 . Huddling identifies a consecutive arc; M_5 turns that arc into the diatonic orbit; the Abel engine independently selects that same orbit. The conjunction of the two characterizations gives the formal connection.

Theorem 3 (Fourier–energy equivalence). *For every strictly admissible V and every seven-element $A \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_{12}$,*

$$|\widehat{A}(5)| = 2 + \sqrt{3} \iff E_V(A) = E_V(D).$$

Both sides hold precisely for the twelve transpositions of D .

Proof. Equation (4) identifies the left-hand equality class with $\mathcal{O}_D$. Theorem 2 identifies the right-hand equality class with $\mathcal{O}_D$. This is `DiatonicExtremality.spectral_energy_equivalence`. $\square$

For the concrete strictly admissible potential $V_0(j) = (7 - j)^2$, the diatonic interval vector is $(2, 5, 4, 3, 6, 1)$ and its energy is 313. Figure 2 shows all seven-note sets in the two measurements. It illustrates the shared equality class; the theorem quantifies over every strict admissible V , not just this plotted example.

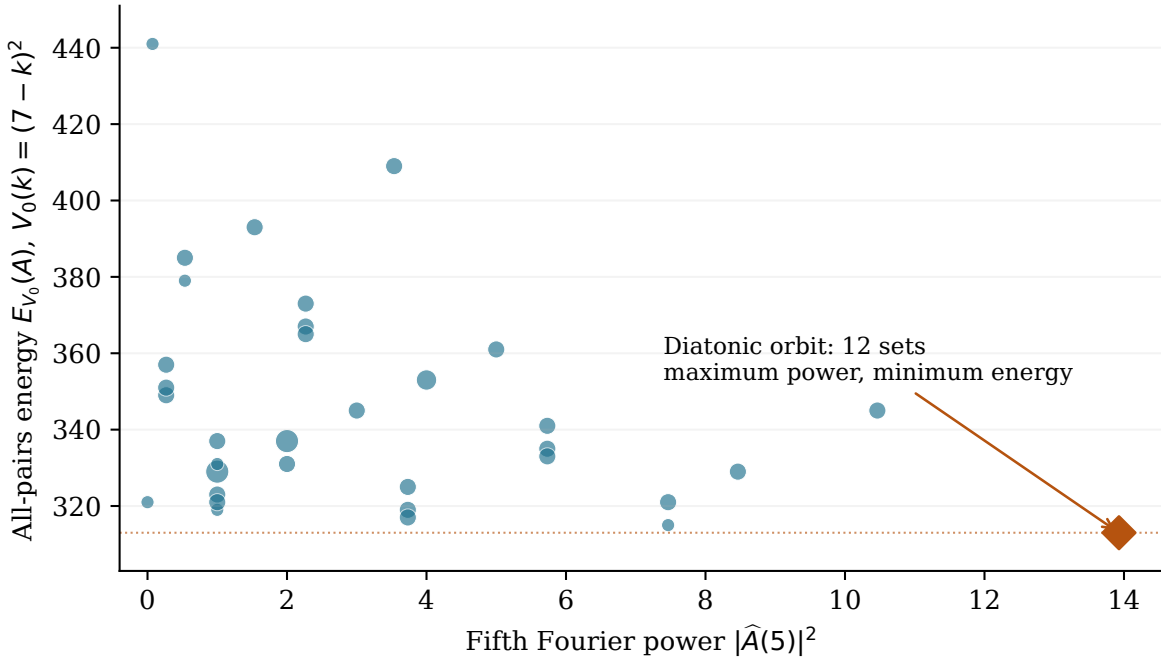


Figure 2: All 792 seven-note sets, grouped into 34 exact (Fourier power, energy) classes; marker area increases with multiplicity. The diamond represents the twelve diatonic transpositions, simultaneously at the largest S_5 and the smallest E_{V_0} . Coordinates are computed exactly before conversion to plotting numbers. Coincidence of the optimizers does not assert an ordering correspondence for every pair of sets.

The previous note on the per-voice Fourier signature [9] used a_5 to measure diatonic character in duration-weighted distributions. The present theorem explains the extremal set interpretation of that name. Its domain is binary indicators at cardinality seven: arbitrary duration weights require their own constraints, and the empirical voice findings do not follow from this finite-set theorem.

6 What happens to the five notes left over?

P₄. Do the black keys inherit both extremal properties of the white keys?

Let $P = \{0, 2, 4, 7, 9\}$ be the anhemitonic pentatonic collection. The five black keys form $D^c = T_6P$. Complementation is already part of the Fourier language of Note 2 [10]: for $t \neq 0$, $\widehat{A^c}(t) = -\widehat{A}(t)$, so the magnitudes agree. This identity and the complement closure of maximal evenness are classical [4]. The energy side requires keeping track of the unordered tritone convention. Our symbolic proof first counts common tones under transposition:

$$|A^c \cap T_t A^c| + 2|A| = 12 + |A \cap T_t A|.$$

Consequently, $i_j(A^c) - i_j(A) = 12 - 2|A|$ for $1 \leq j \leq 5$, and $i_6(A^c) - i_6(A) = 6 - |A|$. Multiplying by the potential gives

$$E_V(A^c) - E_V(A) = (6 - |A|) \left(2 \sum_{j=1}^5 V(j) + V(6) \right). \quad (8)$$

No convexity is needed for this identity. It is the C_{12} instance of the stronger distance-degree-regular graph theorem of Bushaw, Cody, and Leffler [7, Theorem 3.5]. For $|A| = 5$, comparison with D and $D^c = T_6P$ yields the exact gap identity

$$E_V(A) - E_V(P) = E_V(A^c) - E_V(D).$$

Thus the five-note problem is obtained from the seven-note problem by a bijection, with the energy difference preserved and the fifth Fourier coefficient negated.

Theorem 4 (Pentatonic extremality). *For every five-element $A \subseteq \mathbb{Z}_{12}$, $|\widehat{A}(5)| \leq 2 + \sqrt{3}$. For every admissible V , $E_V(P) \leq E_V(A)$. Under strict admissibility,*

$$|\widehat{A}(5)| = 2 + \sqrt{3} \iff E_V(A) = E_V(P) \iff A = T_s P \text{ for some } s.$$

The Lean proof uses the same two finite certificates as the diatonic result. The complement bridge itself is symbolic. This also closes the opening piano image: the white and black keys solve complementary problems, rather than providing unrelated examples of regularity.

7 What the earlier notes can now say

P₅. Can a measurement that forgets phase still identify this scale?

Note 2 studies homometry: equality of autocorrelation, equivalently of Fourier power. Our bridge between its ordered interval counts and the unordered counts in Equation (5) proves

$$A \text{ and } B \text{ homometric} \implies E_V(A) = E_V(B) \text{ for every } V.$$

This is a consequence of the classical equivalent descriptions of homometry [8]. For general sets, pair energies cannot recover phase or distinguish a nontrivial homometric pair. At the diatonic extremum, however, spectral uniqueness implies

$$A \text{ homometric to } D \iff A \in \mathcal{O}_D.$$

The equality class is rigid enough that forgetting phase leaves only the expected transposition ambiguity. This corollary links the earlier phase question directly to extremality; it is not claimed as a new mathematical theorem.

The same coordinate map also links the tritone of Note 1 [11] to the parity channel of Note 4 [9]. Since $5 \cdot 6 = 6 \pmod{12}$,

$$\widehat{M_5 A}(6) = \widehat{A}(6), \quad M_5(T_6 A) = T_6(M_5 A).$$

Thus M_5 exchanges the chromatic and diatonic Fourier coordinates while preserving the sixth coefficient and commuting with the central tritone transposition. These identities do not assert that a diatonic set has the 6-30 stabilizer, or explain a duration-weighted corpus effect by themselves.

Finally, Note 3's Tonnetz spectrum [12] contains $2 \cos(\pi/12)$ as the fifth-frequency magnitude of a generating *triad*. Here the extremal *seven-note scale* has magnitude $2 + \sqrt{3}$. The common Fourier coordinate connects the measurements; their different cardinalities explain the different constants.

8 What is machine-checked

P₆. Where are the links in this argument checked?

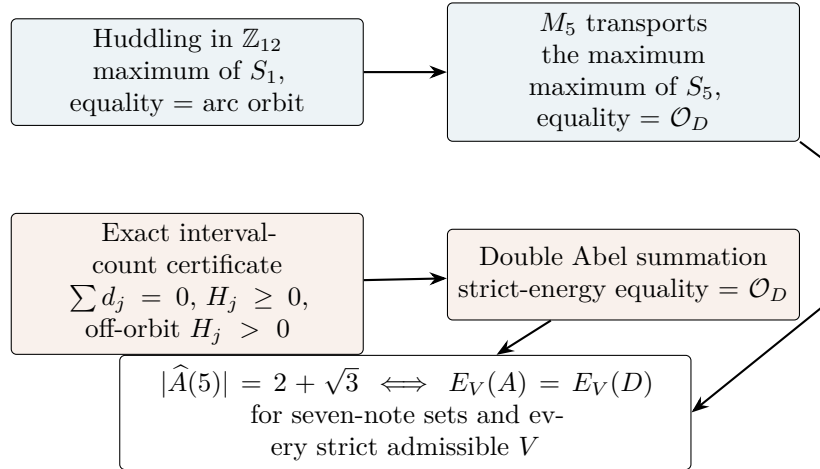


Figure 3: The proof has two routes to the same equality class. The Fourier route uses Huddling and the index permutation; the energy route uses finite integer counts and a symbolic identity. The final theorem joins the routes rather than repeating two separate optimization claims.

The file `ExtremalityConnections.lean` adds the connections in Sections 6–7:

```

energy_eq_of_homometric, diatonic_homometric_iff;
m5_preserves_a6, m5_commutates_tritone;
energy_compl, pentatonic_energy_gap;
pentatonic_spectral_energy_equivalence.

```

The development pins Lean 4.30.0-rc2 and Mathlib commit 701fb6e9c3b9 (the full revision is in `lakefile.lean`). The two new finite censuses use `native_decide` on exact arithmetic. This adds trusted compiled-evaluation dependencies to the ordinary foundational axioms `propext`, `Classical.choice`, and `Quot.sound`; it is not kernel reduction of the entire census. The explicit `#print axioms` output accompanies the build. The symbolic Fourier transport and Abel identity

Lean declaration	Role in the argument
<code>MTransform.Ahat_mul</code>	Unit multiplication permutes Fourier indices.
<code>MTransform.powerSpec_one_re_le_iff</code>	Exact $\mathbb{Z}[\sqrt{3}]$ comparison equals real power comparison.
<code>Huddling.arc_maximizes_power</code> , <code>arc_unique</code>	All-cardinality Huddling inequality and equality class in $\mathbb{Z}_{12}$.
<code>Huddling.fifth_frequency_unique</code>	Transports the complete equality characterization through M_5 .
<code>DiatonicExtremality.diatonic_norm_unique</code>	The seven-note maximum is $2 + \sqrt{3}$, exactly on $\mathcal{O}_D$.
<code>AllPairsEvenness.abel_bridge</code>	Symbolic double summation by parts, for arbitrary real potentials.
<code>DiatonicExtremality.diatonic_energy_unique</code>	The same orbit is the strict-energy equality class.
<code>DiatonicExtremality.spectral_energy_equivalence</code>	The joined Fourier–energy theorem.

Table 2: The statements behind the narrative. Unqualified names in the Huddling row belong to the same namespace.

use only the ordinary foundational axioms; the final extremality theorem also inherits the two census dependencies. The earlier `AllPairsEvenness` file contains its own native census theorems, but the new interface reuses its symbolic engine with the separately audited seven-note certificate. No `sorry`, `admit`, or handwritten mathematical axiom is used.

Independent checks use two arithmetic routes: integer pairs (P, Q) in `huddling_verify.py`, and $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_{12})$ with exact algebraic-real comparisons in `sage/huddling_check.py`. The latter computes Fourier sums directly, independently of Equation (3). Both verify all 4096 sets and all 792 seven-note frequency-five cases. They support reproducibility; the Lean artifact specifies the theorem.

9 Novelty, scope, and what this note does not claim

Huddling, the Fourier index permutation, maximal evenness, and the energy viewpoint are classical [3, 5, 2, 6]. The contribution here is their connected formalization with the complete twelve-tone equality conditions, and the explicit theorem joining the spectral and energy optimizers. The conjunction of published equality-class characterizations is a corollary, not a new characterization. Complement-energy transport is likewise covered in greater generality by Bushaw, Cody, and Leffler [7, Theorems 2.16 and 3.5]; the homometry and parity connections follow from classical identities. It extends the earlier Fourier and Abel machinery in this project.

The statement-level literature audit is recorded in `literature_novelty_2026-10-03.json`. It separates published theorems, their consequences, and the question of proof-assistant implementation. The targeted review establishes positive antecedents for the central mathematics; it does not claim an exhaustive survey of every manuscript.

A dated overlap audit searched the October 3, 2026 Mathlib source snapshot (8592 Lean files) and the checked Prismriver snapshot (35 Lean files), inspected their relevant Fourier and music modules, and ran indexed Huddling searches for Lean, Coq/Rocq, Isabelle, and Agda. No matching formalization was located in those sources. The audit records revisions, queries, and coverage in `formalization_prior_art_2026-10-03.json`; a negative indexed search cannot establish absence from every public or private codebase. Related Christoffel-word results do exist in another Lean project and require a separate overlap review.

All Huddling statements in this note use $\mathbb{Z}_{12}$; the joined energy statements fix cardinalities seven and five. We do not infer an arbitrary-universe formal theorem from this finite census, or identify the energy optimizer with the fifth-frequency optimizer at every other cardinality. The theorem

concerns unweighted sets, not melodic order, tonics, acoustic consonance, or the historical origin of the diatonic scale.

Coda: where the question leads

The starting question has an exact answer: the seven white keys belong to one orbit selected by two different objective functions, and M_5 connects the Fourier maximum to a consecutive cluster. The resulting formalization leaves a concrete next question.

Can the finite Huddling certificate be replaced by a structural Lean proof for arbitrary roots of unity, retaining the full equality condition?

The mathematical theorem already exists; the next task is to make its geometric argument reusable in a proof assistant. Once that is available, the same coordinate change can be studied for other cyclic universes. A further question is then precise rather than metaphorical: which Fourier frequency and cardinality select the same orbit as a given convex-energy problem? The present seven-of-twelve result supplies one checked instance and a shared interface on which to build.

Data and code availability

The source files `Huddling.lean`, `DiatonicExtremality.lean`, `ExtremalityConnections.lean`, `MTransform.lean`, `Fourier.lean`, and `AllPairsEvenness.lean` accompany this note, together with the exact verification and figure scripts, the dated overlap audit, and the pinned Lake configuration. The figure is reproducible from the code; no corpus measurements are introduced in this note.

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